

Yunbo Guo

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Portfolio: yunboguoandy0603.github.io/portfolio

EDUCATION

University College London (UCL)

MA Digital Media: Production

London, UK

09/2025 – 09/2026

Overall classification: pending (dissertation submitted 09/2026)

Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University (XJTLU) / University of Liverpool

BA (Hons) Art Technology and Entertainment with Contemporary Entrepreneurialism

Suzhou, China

09/2020 – 08/2025

Dual award of XJTLU and the University of Liverpool (UK). Classification: Upper Second Class Honours (2:1). All teaching and assessment in English.

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

Summer School

Los Angeles, USA

06/2024 – 08/2024

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Practice-based game design; queer game studies and how queer players in Chinese-speaking communities read games; Sinophone and East Asian games, place and marginalisation; VR/AR and embodied interaction (gaze, electromyography); procedural rhetoric and rogue-lite systems.

SKILLS

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native); English (fluent; TOEFL iBT 104 — R28, L28, S23, W25).

Game & interactive development: Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprint & C++, Gameplay Ability System, Niagara, Level Streaming, Nanite), Unity (C#), GDevelop, Three.js, Processing, Spline; Perforce (Helix Core); Excel-to-DataTable pipelines (Node.js).

XR & sensors: VR on Meta Quest 2 and HTC Vive Pro; AR via ARTIVIVE; electromyography (EMG) as game input.

3D, visual & motion: Blender, Cinema 4D, Autodesk Maya, Substance 3D Painter, TouchDesigner; Adobe Photoshop (Adobe Certified Professional), Illustrator, InDesign, Lightroom, After Effects, Premiere Pro.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Shattered Jade — master's dissertation game, UCL Institute of Education

02/2026 – 09/2026

Practice-based research. Dissertation: *Proceduralising Filial Pressure and Queer Survival in a Sinophone Exorcism Rogue-lite*

- Designed and built a Daoist-exorcism survival rogue-lite in Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprint & C++, Gameplay Ability System, Niagara, UMG, Enhanced Input), solo, with Perforce (Helix Core) version control.
- Proceduralised family pressure as systems rather than story: each enemy stands for one form of pressure, written talismans and spoken mantras form the spell grammar, the core action is dispelling (qusha) rather than killing, and a "shattered jade" upgrade economy feeds a between-run shop.
- Implemented a DataTable-driven spell framework (Excel → Node.js → CSV → UE5) with cooldown and refinement logic, a dual auto-/cursor-aim controller, and a C++ upgrade-system ActorComponent.
- Framed through procedural rhetoric, queer game studies and Sinophone studies; reported every design decision and dead end, and kept a bilingual development journal as reflexive data on designing about family expectation from a distance.

Babel Refractions: A VR Journey Through Modern Alienation

01/2025 – 05/2025

Undergraduate final-year project (individual)

- Designed and built four metaphorical VR worlds (rules, slogans, industry, goals) in Unreal Engine, with Maya and Blender, so that modern pressure is felt rather than read.
- Ran user testing with 18 participants on Meta Quest 2 and HTC Vive Pro, about 15 minutes per session, and revised interaction and pacing from the sessions.
- Produced Hyper Glimpse, a 24-page printed catalogue of the project (InDesign, Photoshop, Lightroom); the workflow became an official teaching case for CAT209 at XJTLU, where I served as teaching assistant.

Primal Hunting: A VR + EMG Game on Rehabilitation and Industrial Alienation

04/2024 – 06/2024

Game design, VR and EMG integration

- Designed a VR archery game in Unreal Engine 5 driven by electromyography: muscle signals from EMG sensors set bow draw and arrow power, so physical effort is the core mechanic.
- Designed the loop as a rehabilitation exercise that is also play; the world moves from nature to machine, after Chaplin's Modern Times; integrated the EMG hardware with UE5 physics and VR interaction.

SELECTED CREATIVE PROJECTS & EXHIBITIONS

- One More Step — 2D puzzle game, UCL Institute of Education (with Emily Ng)** 01/2026 – 03/2026
- Six-level Sokoban on the invisible labour of the student commute; designed all game logic and levels in GDevelop with distance-based detection for reliable interaction; applied procedural rhetoric and "abusive game design". Playable in the browser.
- Deep Time — mixed-media AR installation** 02/2023
- Walk-in installation on the Proust effect: real scents trigger memories shown as projected video (three projectors, nine gauze screens, 12.95 × 11.74 × 4 m) with AR layers via ARTIVIVE; UE5 Niagara and Cinema 4D.
- Paranoid's Dream — VR narrative experiment** 02/2023 – 06/2023
- UE5 VR piece on mental health and digital identity: gaze-based interaction, dynamic material transitions and seamless looping environments via Level Streaming; environment art in Maya and Substance 3D Painter.
- Space of Another Reality: Time and Order — virtual exhibition, published on Steam** 06/2022 – 07/2022
- Authored the "Time and Order" hall of a first-person virtual museum (UE5, Maya, Blender): dream-like scenes on scale and social rules, with giant statues after the Leshan Buddha.
- "Plastic Material Reuse" exhibition, Nan Art Museum** 10/2023 – 12/2023
- Collected and documented domestic waste and the stories behind it; co-created works with other artists; curatorial writing, world-building and photography.
- "201" Art Exhibition: MISTAKE** 12/2022
- AI-generated exhibition content and digital lighting design for an exhibition with 300+ visitors.

INTERNSHIPS

- Gansu Culture Tourism Network Television Development Co., Ltd — Design Intern, Lanzhou** 07/2023 – 09/2023
- Post-production for broadcast programmes (visual design, lighting, sound, captions) in Premiere Pro and After Effects; posters and advertisements for the marketing department.
- Dushu Lake Theatre — Design & Marketing Intern, Suzhou** 06/2023 – 07/2023
- Recorded in-house performances; promotional video, posters and social media for the film I Love You; the theatre's year-round holiday posters.
- Gansu Xinghao Interactive Culture Communication Co., Ltd — Design Intern, Lanzhou** 01/2023 – 02/2023
- Poster and website design; marketing video and social-media content.

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

- XJTLU Diversity Association — Head of Activities** 02/2021 – 09/2022
- Planned and ran large themed events (budget, guests, logistics, staffing); negotiated resources with the university and neighbouring universities; promoted equality and supported women's and LGBTQ+ rights.
 - World AIDS Day workshop: expert lectures attended by 100+ students; coordinated campus distribution of HIV self-test kits and condoms. International Women's Day: roses-and-postcards exchange with 200+ participants and 3,000+ social-media views.
- Sport and interests: Ultimate Frisbee (3rd, Shanghai University Ultimate Invitational); swimming (3rd, men's 50 m freestyle, 1st XJTLU Aquatic Games); football, guitar, photography, handicrafts.